WEIGHT 10

Orforglipron

Small-molecule GLP-1 receptor agonist taken as a daily tablet; not a peptide



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Small molecule	Weight, type 2 diabetes	Large trials; FDA approved	FDA approved (Foundayo)

STUDIED FOR

Body weight	Blood sugar	Heart safety
HUMAN	HUMAN	HUMAN

US approval is for weight only. Use for type 2 diabetes alone is off-label in the US. The UK authorised it for weight and type 2 diabetes.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Orforglipron → GLP-1 receptor → Less appetite → Lower food intake

- **Binds and activates** the human GLP-1 receptor (label)
- **Lowers food intake,** likely by lowering appetite, and slows stomach emptying
- **Brain appetite areas** reached by the drug in animal studies
- **Not active** in rats or mice, per the label

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- ATTAIN-1: 3,127 adults, 72 weeks
- ATTAIN-2: 1,613 adults with type 2 diabetes
- ACHIEVE-4 heart safety: 2,749 adults

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Thyroid tumor risk in people

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
About 29 to 49 hours (Foundayo label)	By mouth, once daily (tablet)
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Peak 4 to 8 hours; liver metabolism (CYP3A4)	Prescription tablets (Foundayo)
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Weight, HbA1c, pulse in trials	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved: Foundayo, Apr 2026, weight
MHRA	Authorised Aug 2026: weight, type 2 diabetes
EMA	Positive CHMP opinion, Oct 2026
WADA	Not prohibited

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Foundayo prescribing information, Jul 2026
2. Wharton et al., ATTAIN-1, N Engl J Med, Nov 2025
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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